SKULBASE USER GUIDE

Bursar and finance guide

For bursars and accountants

Billing the term from fee structures and vote heads, bursaries and waivers, each learner's fee account and statement, recording payments and receipts, who owes and fee reminders, the collections report, and spending through payment vouchers.

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CHAPTER 1

Getting started

Bursars and accountants sign in with their own account like everyone else. The administrator then assigns the duty under Settings → Roles & duties, and its pages appear in the menu the next time you open Skulbase. You only see a page if your school has switched its module on and your role or duty uses it. If something here is missing from your menu, ask your administrator.

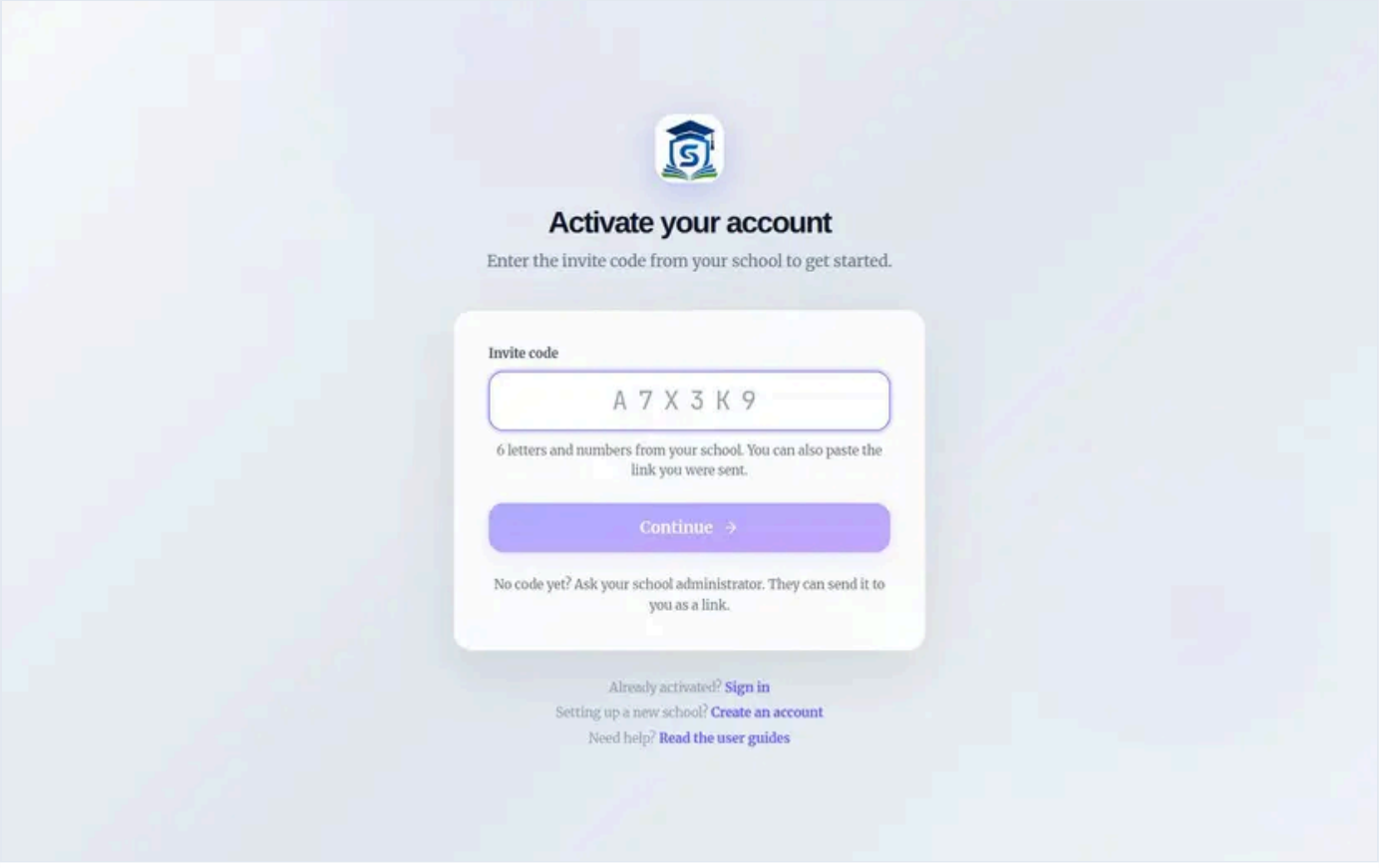
1.1 Who this guide is for

The duties this guide covers, and what each one can do.

- Bursar: fees, billing, expenses and financial reports, including approving vouchers.
- Accountant: records payments and expenses; approvals stay with the bursar or principal.

1.2 Activate your account with an invite code

Teachers, staff and learners do not sign up on their own. Your school adds you, and you get a personal invite code (or a link that has the code in it) to set up your login.



Activating an account: type the invite code from your school, or open the link they sent you.

1. **Get your code**
   Your school administrator gives you a six-character invite code, for example A7X3K9, by SMS, WhatsApp, on paper, or as a link. The code only works for your account.

2. **Open the activation page**
   Tap the link you were sent, or go to skulbase.com, choose Sign in and then “Activate your account”. If you opened a link, the code is already filled in.

3. **Check it is you**
   Press Continue. Skulbase shows the name the school registered. If it is not you, choose “Not you?” and ask the school for the right code.

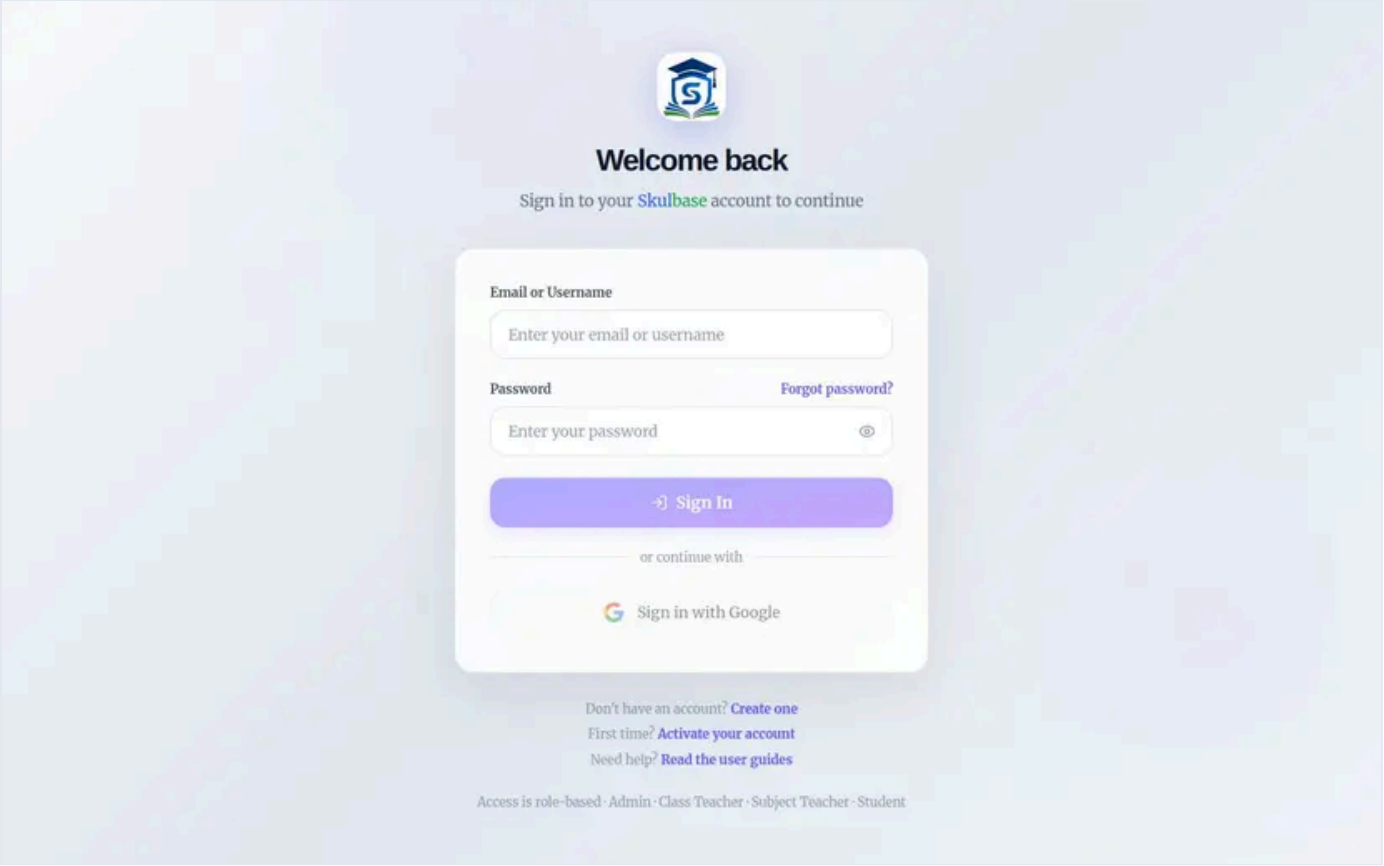
4. **Choose how you will sign in**
   Pick a username (one is suggested for you) and a password of at least 8 characters, or continue with Google. Adding an email address lets you reset your password yourself later.

5. **You are in**
   You are signed in straight away and land on the home page for your role.

⚠ **Good to know:** Each code can be used once. If yours says it has expired or was already used, ask your administrator to reset your account; they get a fresh code in seconds.

1.3 Sign in

Once your account is active, sign in with your email address or username and your password, or with Google if you activated with Google.



The sign-in page. “Forgot password?” sends you a code by email.

1. **Go to the sign-in page**
   Open skulbase.com and choose Sign in.

2. **Enter your details**
   Type your email address or username, then your password, and press Sign In. Or press “Sign in with Google”.

3. **Forgot your password?**
   Choose “Forgot password?”, enter your email address, and type the six-digit code we email you along with a new password. This also works if you have only ever used Google, and afterwards both ways work.

> **Tip:** Save skulbase.com to your phone’s home screen. It opens like an app and remembers you are signed in.

1.4 Finding your way around

The menu only shows the pages your role can use. On a computer it runs down the left-hand side; on a phone the main pages sit in a bar along the bottom.

- On a computer, the arrow at the top of the menu makes it narrower (icons only) or wider (icons and names). Skulbase remembers your choice.
- Press the / key, or tap “Search menu”, to jump to any page by typing part of its name.
- Your name at the bottom of the menu opens your account menu: switch between light and dark appearance, or sign out.
- If you hold more than one role (for example an administrator who is also a class teacher), use “View as” in the account menu to switch views.
- On a phone, the bottom bar shows your four most-used pages. Everything else is under More.

CHAPTER 2

Billing the term

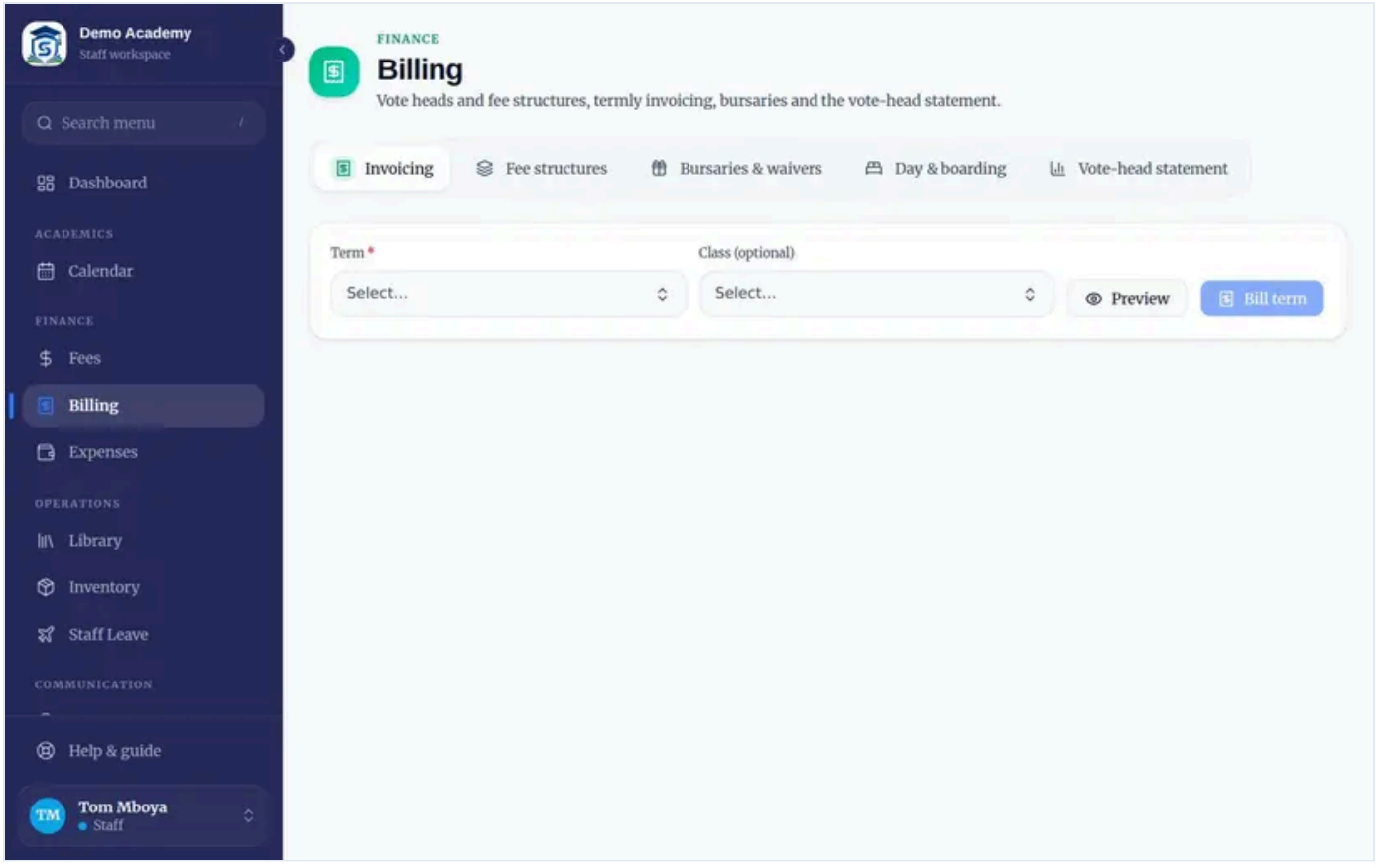
Billing sets what each learner owes, from vote heads and fee structures, and bills a whole term in one go.

2.1 Vote heads

Vote heads are the accounts fees are split into (tuition, exams, boarding, transport and so on). Add each with a name, a short code and an allocation order: payments are allocated to vote heads in that order.

2.2 Fee structures

A fee structure is the year's fees for a class level, for day scholars, boarders or both: an amount for the year per vote head, and the share billed each term (for example 50%, 30% and 20%).



Billing: Invoicing, Fee structures, Bursaries & waivers, Day & boarding, and the vote-head statement.

2.3 Day scholars and boarders

On “Day & boarding”, mark each learner as a day scholar or a boarder (a whole class at once, or one by one), so they are billed from the right structure.

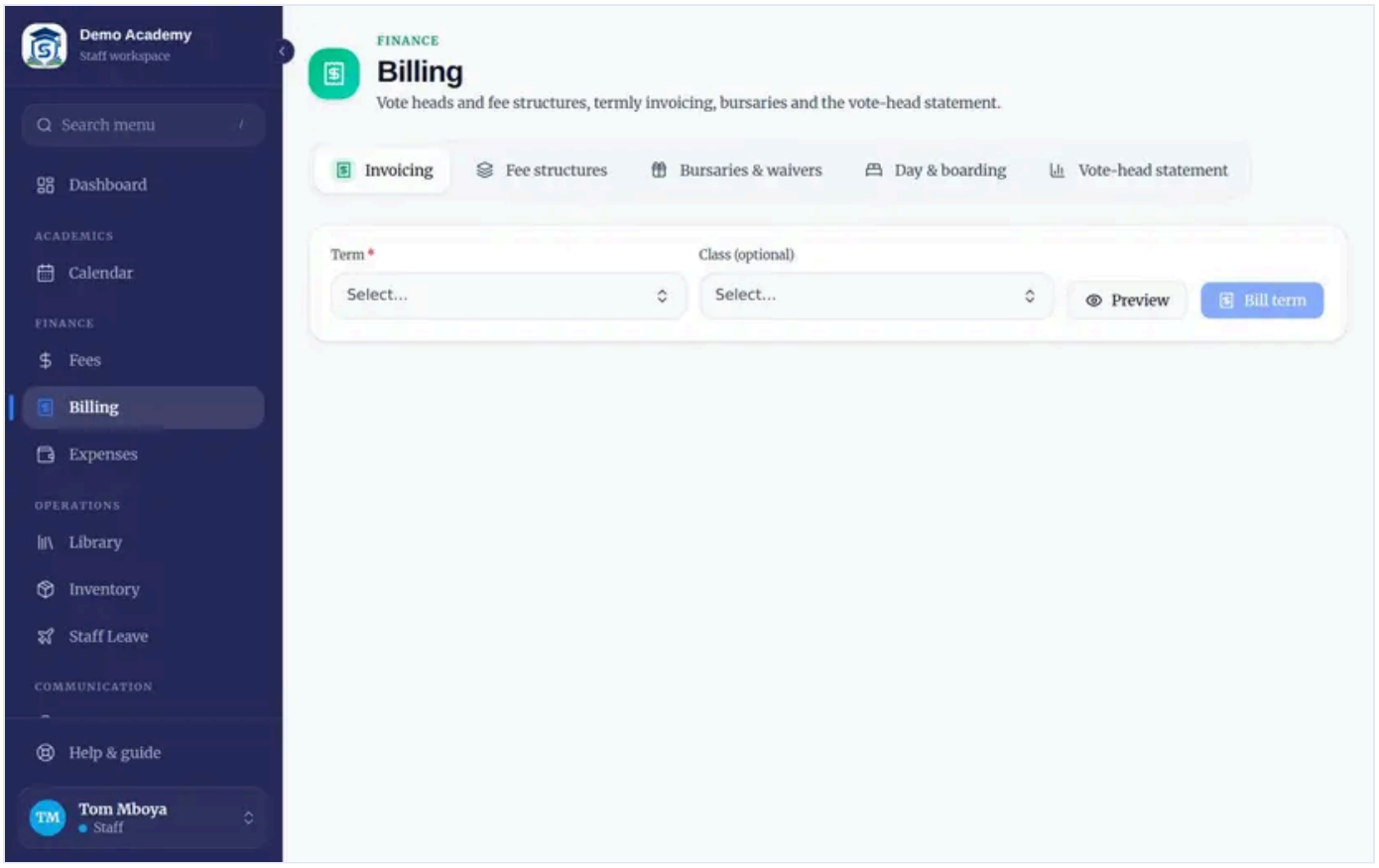
2.4 Bursaries and waivers

Record a bursary, scholarship, waiver or discount for a learner and term: the amount, the sponsor (for example CDF) and a reference. Awards reduce what the learner owes when the term is billed.

> ⚠ **Good to know:** If you add an award after billing, bill the term again so it is taken off.

2.5 Bill the term

On Invoicing, choose the term (and a class, if you like) and press Preview.



Invoicing: preview first, then bill the term.

1. **Preview**
   Every learner is listed with the amount from their structure, less any awards. Learners with no structure are skipped and listed so you can fix them.

2 **Bill**

Press “Bill term” and confirm. Each learner’s fee record for the term is created or updated on the Fees page.

2.6 Vote-head statement and reminders

The vote-head statement shows, for a term, what was billed and collected under each vote head. “Balance reminders” texts the parents of learners who owe at least an amount you choose: every linked parent and the number on the learner’s record. Fees → Who owes sends the same reminders after a preview.

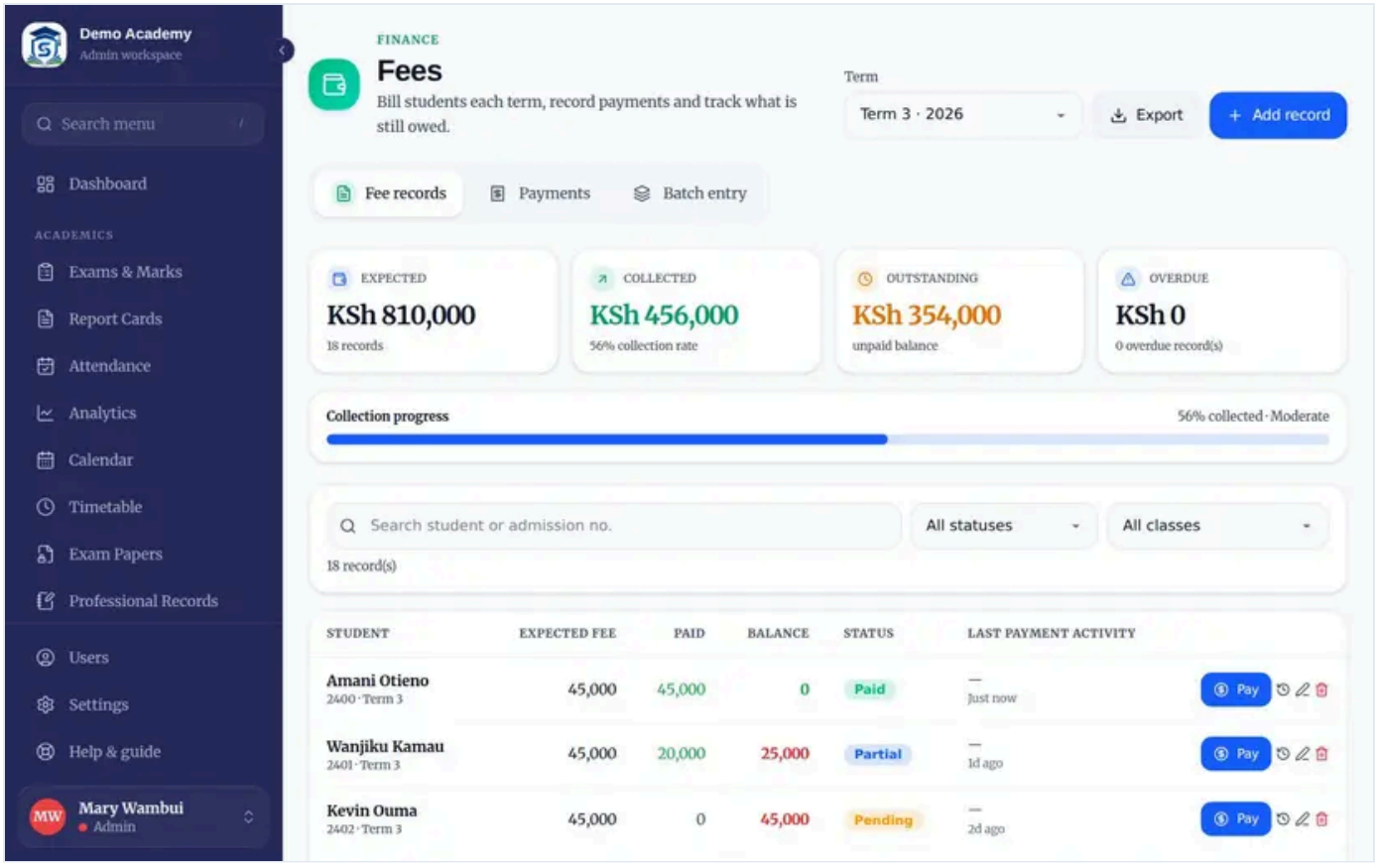
CHAPTER 3

Fees

The Fees page is where each learner's balance lives: their fee account and statement, payments and receipts, who owes, and what came in.

3.1 Fee records

The Fee records tab shows the chosen term's totals (expected, collected, outstanding, overdue), a collection progress bar, and one row per learner.



Fees → Fee records for the chosen term.

- Choose the term at the top. Search by learner or admission number, or filter by status and class.
- Click a learner's row to open their fee account (below).
- Each row also has Pay (record a payment), payment history with receipts, edit and delete. "Add record" bills one learner; "Export" downloads the list as a spreadsheet.
- Finance staff get links from Fees to fee structures and invoicing, the payment channels, and linking a class's parents.

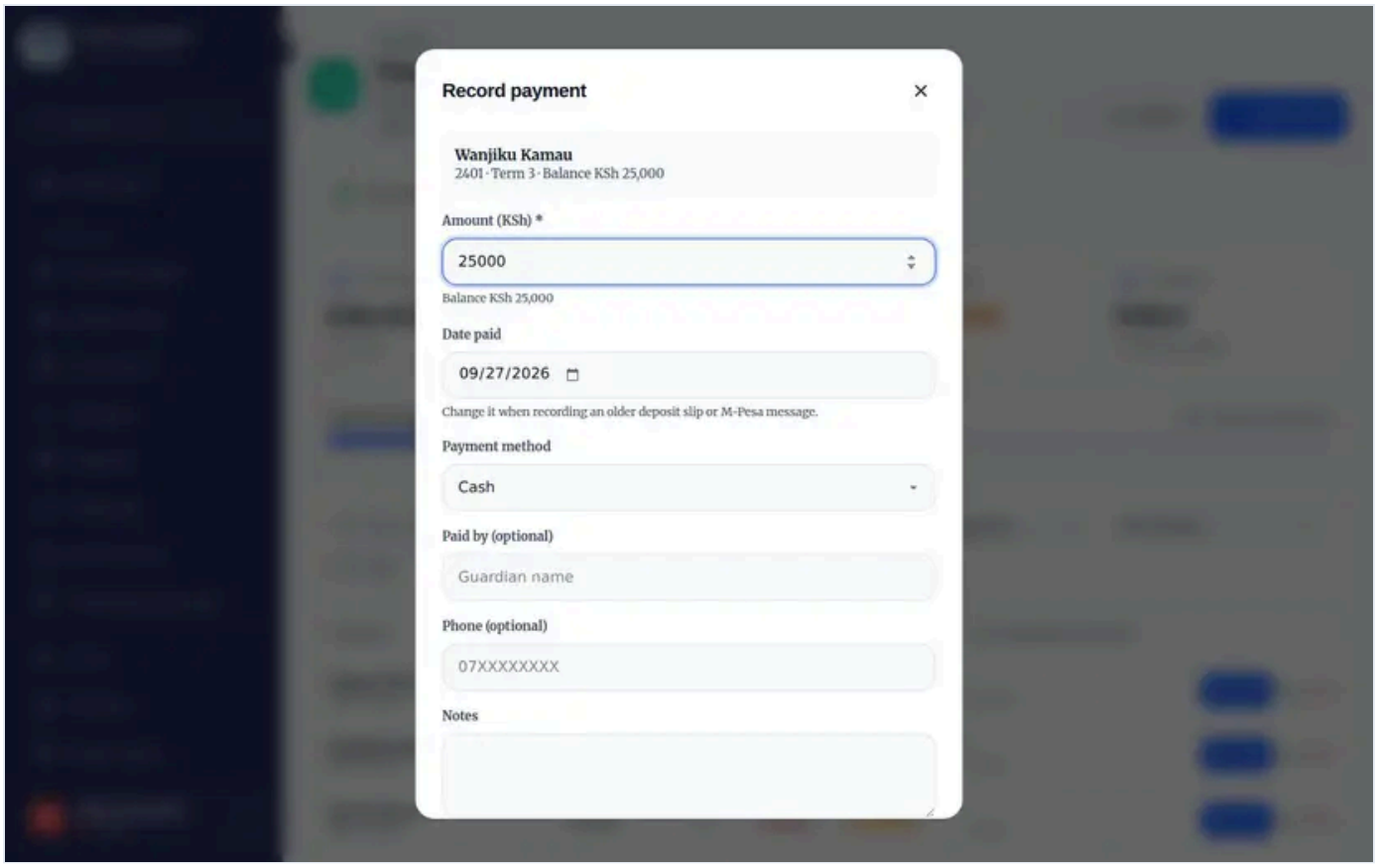
3.2 A learner's fee account and statement

A learner's fee account puts everything about their fees in one place: what they owe across every term (arrears carried forward), each term's bill with its vote heads and bursaries, every payment with its receipt, and the parents to call or text.

1. **Open it**
   Click the learner's row on Fee records or on Who owes.
2. **Read the balance**
   The top shows the balance due (or credit) across all terms, what was billed and paid, and any arrears from earlier terms.
3. **Call the parent**
   The parents linked to the learner, and the contact on their record, are listed with their phone numbers. If nobody is linked you can link a parent on the spot.
4. **Record a payment**
   "Record payment" records money against the oldest term still owing, so arrears clear before the current bill.
5. **Give the statement**
   "Statement" downloads a PDF listing every charge, bursary and payment with a running balance, and how to pay (the Paybill with the admission number as the account, and bank accounts). Hand it to a parent or send it on WhatsApp.

3.3 Record a payment

For cash, cheques, bank deposits and M-Pesa messages you receive yourself. Payments made online from the learner's or a parent's Fees page are recorded automatically.



Record payment: the amount is filled with the balance; change it for a part payment.

1. **Press Pay**
   On the learner's row, or "Record payment" in their fee account.
2. **Enter the payment**
   Type the amount, the date paid (change it when recording an older slip), the method and, optionally, who paid and a note.
3. **Save**
   The balance updates straight away, and the receipt is in the payment history and the fee account.

⚠ **Good to know:** An administrator can void a payment recorded by mistake from the payment history. The receipt then shows as voided when anyone checks it.

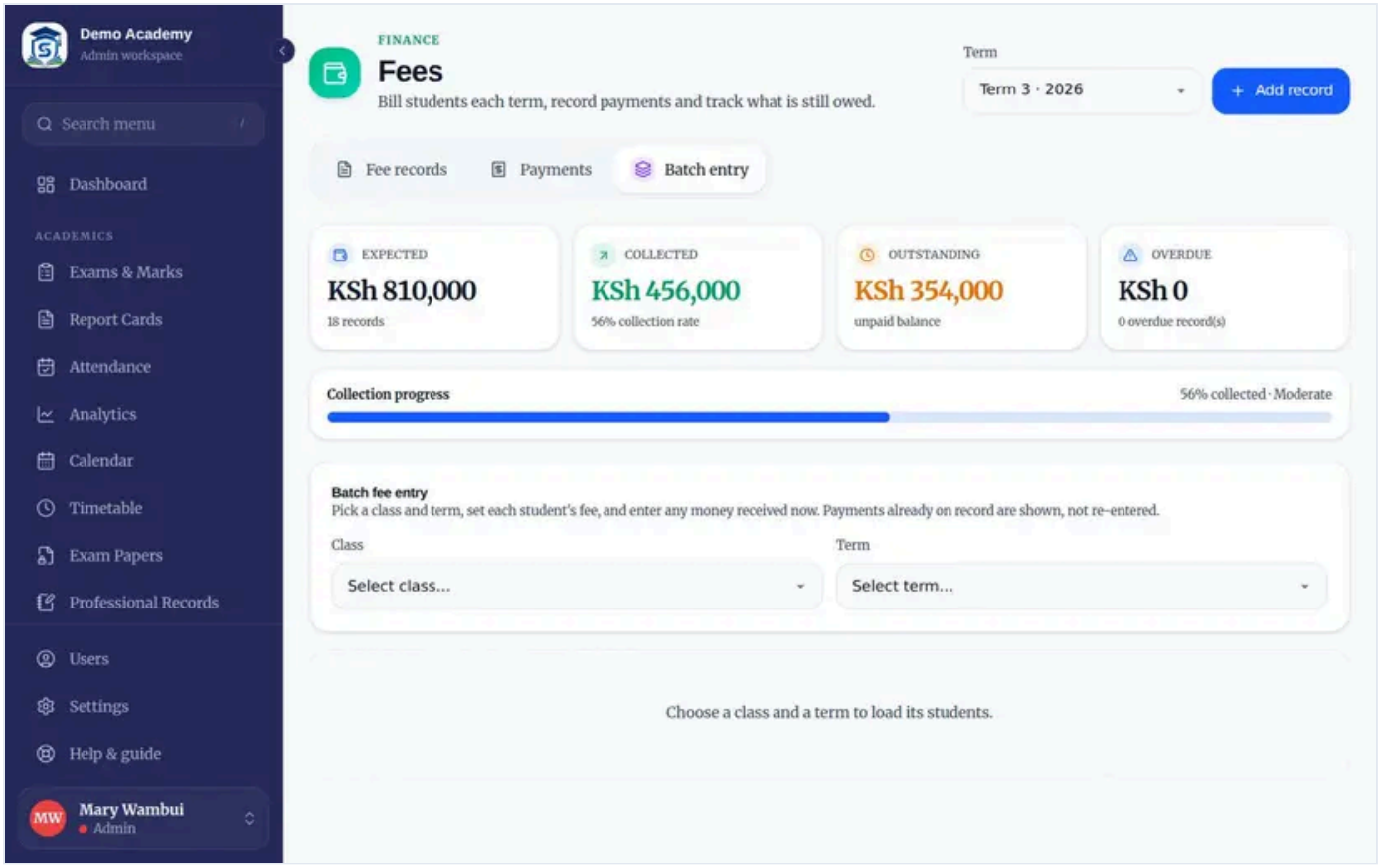
3.4 Receipts and checking one is genuine

Every completed payment has an A5 receipt, ready to print or share. It shows who paid for which learner, the amount in figures and words, the M-Pesa or bank code, what the payment paid for (the term's vote heads, in priority order), the term balance, arrears from earlier terms and the total still due, all as they stood right after the payment, so a reprint matches the original.

- The receipt carries the school's contacts and a QR code. Scanning it opens a Skulbase page that says whether the receipt is genuine, voided or not yet confirmed, with the receipt number, amount, date and the learner's first name only.
- Receipts are only issued for confirmed payments. An online payment still waiting for confirmation has no receipt yet.

3.5 Bill a whole class at once

The Batch entry tab bills every learner in a class for the term in one go. Schools with fee structures usually bill from Billing → Invoicing instead.



Fees → Batch entry.

1. **Choose the class and term**
   Every active learner in the class is listed.
2. **Set the fee**
   Type the fee once and press Apply to fill it for everyone, and set one due date. Change any learner's fee individually if needed.
3. **Record payments now (optional)**
   Enter any payment already received in "Payment now"; "Balance after" updates as you type.

4. **Save all**
   Press “Save all”. Learners already billed for the term keep their record and are updated rather than billed twice.

3.6 Who owes, and fee reminders

The Who owes tab lists every learner owing across all their terms, most owed first: how much, how long it has been overdue, how many terms are owing, when they last paid, and the parent to call (a linked parent before the contact on the learner’s record).

1. **Narrow it down**
   Filter by class, and set “Over KSh” to leave out small balances. The figures above show how many learners owe, the total owed (arrears included) and how many have no parent phone.
2. **Follow one up**
   Tap a phone number to call, or a learner to open their fee account.
3. **Export**
   “Excel” downloads the list for the board or the class teachers.
4. **Text reminders**
   Press “Text reminders”. Skulbase first says how many messages will go to the parents of how many learners, and how many owing learners have no number at all. Confirm to send.

- Each reminder gives the learner’s balance across all terms and, when the school takes M-Pesa, the Paybill and account number.
- Reminders reach every linked parent as well as the number on the learner’s record, once each.
- Learners with no parent phone are counted, not texted. Link their parents under Parent accounts.

3.7 Collections report

The Collections tab shows the money received over a period: today, the last 7 days, this month, the last 30 days or any dates. It gives the total, the number of payments and the daily average, split by method (M-Pesa, cash, bank), by class and by day. Use it for daily banking and the head’s weekly report.

3.8 The payments log and unmatched payments

The Payments tab lists every payment received, filtered by date, method (automatic or manual) and status, with Export beside the search. M-Pesa or bank payments that could not be matched

to a learner (for example a wrong account number) appear with a button to assign them to the right learner.

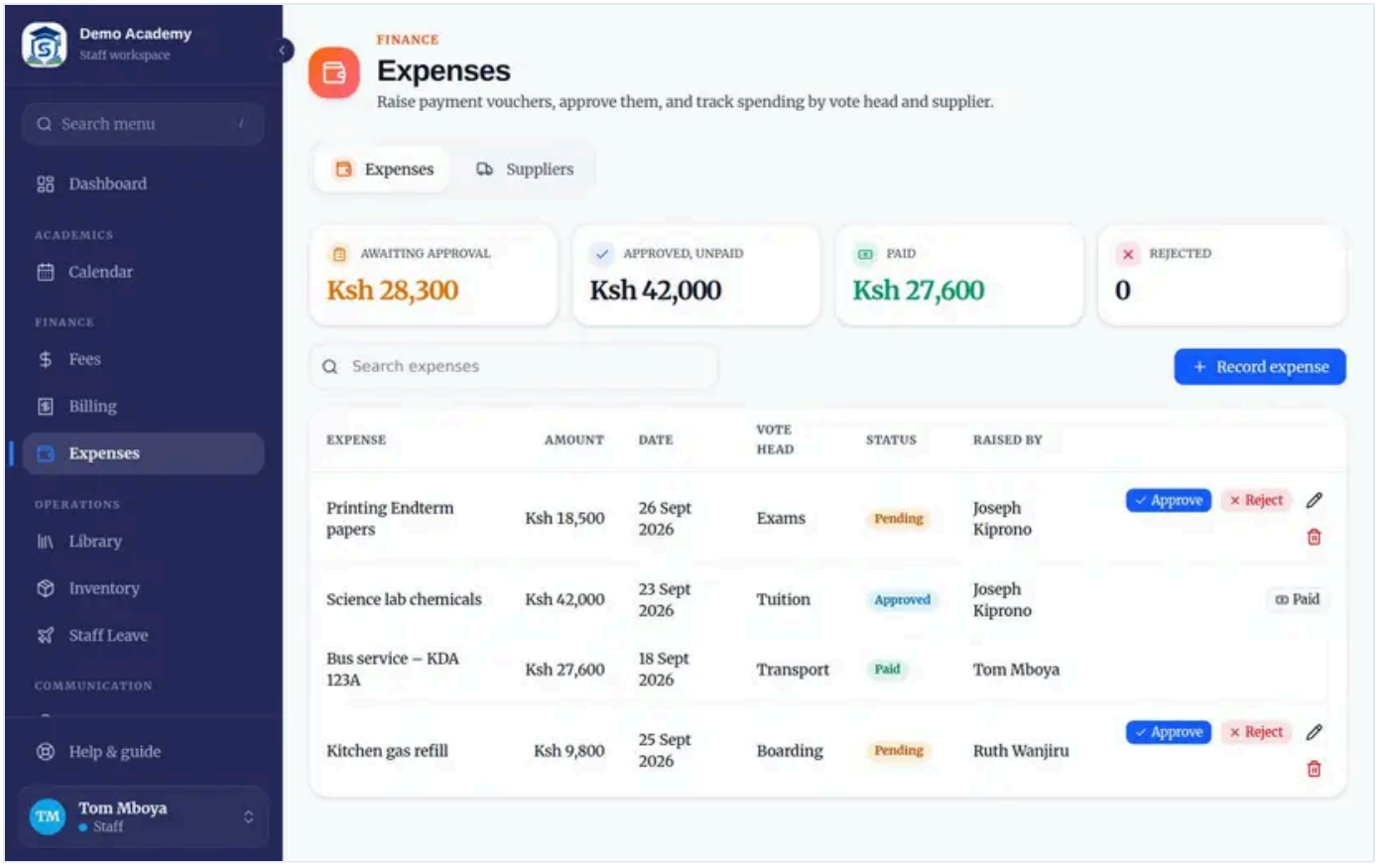
CHAPTER 4

Expenses

Every shilling spent goes through a payment voucher, so spending can be tracked by vote head and supplier.

4.1 Payment vouchers

The Expenses tab shows totals awaiting approval, approved but unpaid, paid and rejected, and every voucher.



Expenses: approve, reject and mark vouchers paid.

1. **Raise a voucher**
   Press “Record expense”: what it is for, the amount, date, supplier, vote head, payment method and invoice reference. Staff raise their own under “My requests”.

2. **Approve or reject (bursar, principal)**
   Use Approve or Reject on each pending voucher.

3. **Pay it**
   When you pay an approved voucher, press Paid and enter who was paid and the reference (cheque number or M-Pesa code).

4.2 Suppliers

The Suppliers tab keeps each supplier’s name, phone, email, KRA PIN and category, so vouchers pick them from a list.

CHAPTER 5

Getting help

Most questions are answered on the page itself: many pages have a “How to” panel at the bottom. For anything else, these are the places to go.

5.1 Where to get help

This guide is always available from Help in the menu, and as a PDF you can download and print.

- Your school administrator can add or reset accounts, fix classes and subjects, and change school settings.
- For problems with Skulbase itself, use the contact page at skulbase.com/contact, or call 0740 129 444.
- When you report a problem, say which page you were on, what you pressed and what you expected. A screenshot helps.